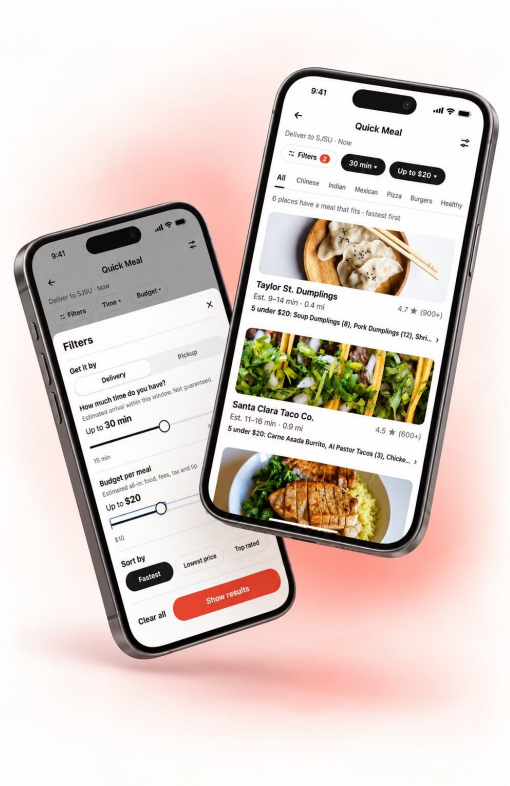
FINAL PRODUCT READOUT

# Quick Meal

**Your meal, found in seconds.**

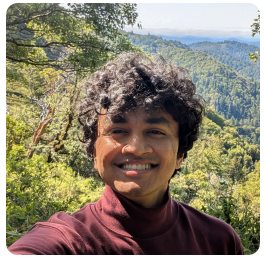



## Team Hungry · DoorDash

**Members:** Sally Li · Michelle Chen · Keerthan Shagrithaya · Siqi Jin · Jinyu Liu











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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# Our Decision: GO

**Quick Meal helps students find meals by time, budget, and meal type. Rule-based, no LLM.**

### WHY BUILD

## 14/15

students struggle to decide what to order. Beachhead: ~68K students.

### WHY NOW

## 6–10 months

to build the habit before the 2027 DashPass renewal

### WHY US

## 67%

of US delivery spend, plus the delivery-time data we already own

**Key learning:** students want **predictable meals** and **low decision effort** more than raw speed.

### THE ASK

**Approve Release 1, a CMU Silicon Valley closed beta.** Target: **≥20% faster ordering, no NPS drop.**

About $0.4M, one-quarter build.

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BUSINESS CASE

# Recover high-intent orders lost in the choice process

## 15 STUDENT INTERVIEWS

**93%**

**say deciding takes too much effort**

(14 of 15)

**100%**

**have a price limit**

(15 of 15)

**80%**

**need food to arrive when promised**

(12 of 15)

**33%**

**abandoned a cart after seeing fees**

(5 of 15)

Students prefer predictable meals and low effort. 49% of US consumers spend 5–10 minutes choosing.

## MARKET

**~68K students Bay Area beachhead (SOM, ~$38M/year)**

9.4M students on DoorDash nationwide (SAM, ~$5.2B/year)

14M students ordering monthly in US (TAM, ~$7.8B/year)

### METRIC

**+5%**

Order rate vs. an 8-week holdout. North Star: cohort order rate.

### VALUE

**$2.6M a year**

Contribution profit at national scale; beachhead adds ~$0.4M. No fee to students.

### COST AND RISK

**~2 engineer-months**

No LLM, so no AI serving cost. Core test only. Full build: ~$0.4M, one quarter, five people. Biggest risk: trusted delivery estimates.

Source: Final Product Plan, Sections 2 and 4. Estimates; dollar figures are upper bounds.

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MARKET WINDOW / RIGHT TO WIN

# Constraint-first ordering is an opportunity now, but it may not stay differentiated for long.

DoorDash already has the data and infrastructure to test Quick Meal before competitors catch up.

### COMPETITORS & DIFFERENTIATION

- **Ask DoorDash:** Conversational discovery/personalized recommendations.
- **Grubhub / Campus Dining:** Student-focused food access and convenient ordering.

**Quick Meal starts with what can actually work within constraints.**

### MARKET WINDOW

**Estimated 6–10 months**

**Why the window is open now:**

- DoorDash and competitors are moving toward lower-effort ordering.
- Students want faster, more predictable decisions.
- DoorDash has the technology needed; testing is relatively cheaper.

**What could close it:**

- Conversational and AI ordering tools start handling hard constraints directly.
- Competitors could introduce similar experiences.
- The student need would remain, but the SAM/SOM we uniquely capture may shrink.

---

### WHY DOORDASH?

- 67% delivery-spend share; 56M+ monthly users
- Order history and preference data
- ETA, preparation-time, and Dasher data
- Existing ordering and delivery infrastructure

Competitive and offer claims: verify sources in Appendix C. Estimated window, not proven moat.

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CUSTOMER / CONCEPT JOURNEY

# From student needs to crunch-time ordering

## USER SCENARIO

### Samira Hadid · Student persona

During an academic crunch period, Samira needs a filling meal within 30 minutes and an all-in budget of $20, with little attention to spare.

*Illustrative persona limits, not interview-wide data.*

| 30 minutes | $20 all-in |
|---|---|

**15/15 interviews mentioned price-worth limits**

**JOB TO BE DONE**

Help me find a filling meal within my limits without spending too long deciding.

## OUR THINKING

**93%**

*of interviewees, for each theme (14/15; n=15)*

**When deadlines hit, choosing a dependable meal takes attention students cannot spare.**

- **Academic time pressure**
- **Decision effort**
- **Need for easy, predictable meals**

*Each theme appeared in 14 of 15 interviews; overlap across themes was not measured.*

**So we put time and budget limits first, helping students choose from meals that fit.**

**Trusted restaurants:** Trusted restaurants were a consistent part of the decision context.

## 3-OPTION CONCEPT COMPARISON

| Concept | RICE | Decision | Why |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Quick Meal** | 300K | **SELECTED** | Priority need; full-price orders; existing data |
| **Student Value** | 210K | NOT NOW | Subsidy effort; easy to copy |
| **Item Reviews** | 125K | LATER | Trust support |

**Product choice:** We dropped payment splitting because choosing a restaurant was the harder problem, and Group Orders already handles payment.

Full framework in Appendix A.

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HYPOTHESIS TRACEABILITY

# Initial Hypotheses and Traceability

| Hypothesis | Interview evidence (n=15) | MVP feature | Type | Artifact | Expansion gate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **H1 reliable crunch meals** | 14 crunch; 12 reliability; 14 decision effort | Filter + no-match | Det. | AC03/05/08 | AC03/05/08 pass; ≥80% arrive in window; time-to-order −20% OR orders +5% |
| **H2 reliable access** | 14 access friction; 4 lack nearby food | Time filter + ETA | Det. | AC03/08 | AC03/08 pass; ≥80% arrive in window; reconsider if pickup-only |
| **H3 price-worth** | 15 price limit; 5 fee abandonment | All-in fees, tax, tip | Det. | AC02/06 | AC02 pass; completion +15% AND frequency +15% |

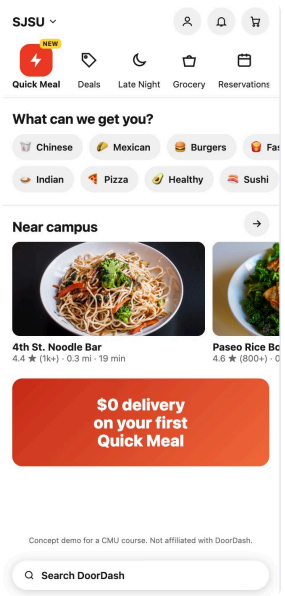
**Dropped hypothesis:** In-app payment splitting was excluded because interviewees found agreeing on a restaurant harder than handling payment, and DoorDash Group Orders already supports separate payment.

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MVP / PHASE 2

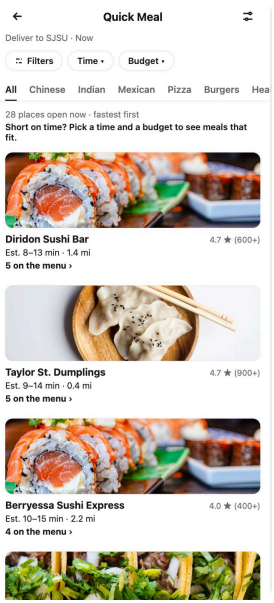
# Quick Meal: from limits to feasible meals.

### Home

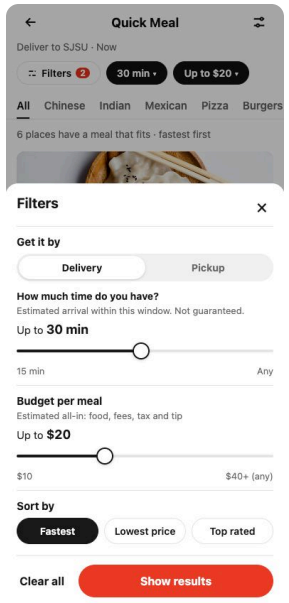



(AC01) Quick Meal Entry

### Quick Meal List

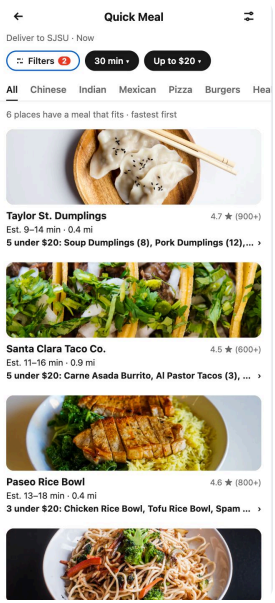



### Filter Sheet



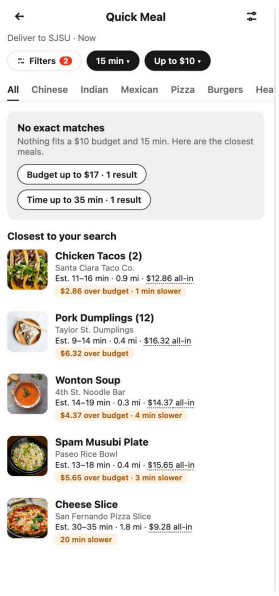

(AC03) 30 min / $20

### Filter Results



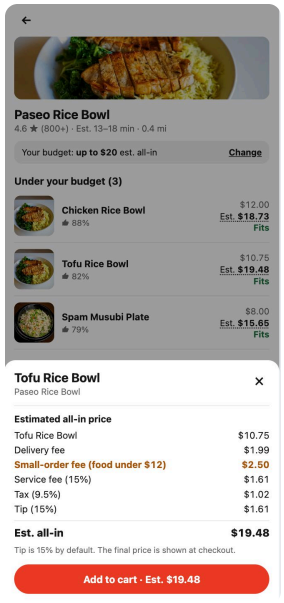

(AC04/08) 6 feasible results + ETA

### No-match




(AC05) relax chips with result counts

### Price Breakdown




Est. all-in price: fees, tax and tip (AC02)

LIVE DEMO: [quick-meal-demo.ioenv.workers.dev](quick-meal-demo.ioenv.workers.dev), Repo: [https://github.com/githonllc/quick-meal-demo](https://github.com/githonllc/quick-meal-demo)

**Scope / status:** No real checkout; estimates, not guarantees. Seven prototype checks reported passed.

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VALIDATION

# 7/7 checks reported passed; real-world impact comes next

**7/7 artifact groups reported passed; business impact untested. Raw five-run counts missing.**

| Artifact | Expected behavior | Verified by | Reported result |
|---|---|---|---|
| AC01/03 Entry + filters | 30 min / $20; 6 cards; chips badge 2 | E2E + walk + screenshot | PASS |
| AC02 Budget | ≤$20; fees add to cent; small-order fee only <$12 | E2E + walk + screenshot | PASS |
| AC04/05 Combine + relax | Chinese 2 vs All 4; $15/$15 none → $17/1; saved $15 unchanged | E2E + walk + screenshot | PASS |
| AC06 Paseo menu | 3 fit; Chicken first; Veggie 0.54 over | E2E + walk + screenshot | PASS |
| AC07 Reopen | 30 min / $20; All 6 | E2E + walk + screenshot | PASS |
| AC08 ETA | Slow end ≤30; estimated range, not guaranteed | E2E + walk + screenshot | PASS |
| AC09 Pickup | 1 mi / $20: 7; no delivery fee; Chicken $16.74 | E2E + walk + screenshot | PASS |

**Finding:** Tofu $10.75 menu / $19.48 total vs Chicken $12 menu / $18.73 total because of the $2.50 small-order fee. Lower menu price can mean higher total.

Source: FINAL plan E2E + manual walk + screenshots.

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ROADMAP

# Start with CMU, test across the Bay Area, expand nationally if results hold

### R1 — CRAWL
**CMU Closed Beta**

**Does Quick Meal work correctly and save time?**

### R2 — WALK
**Bay Area Campuses**

**Does the feature lift orders versus a holdout group?**

### R3 — RUN
**National Rollout**

**Does the gain hold at scale across all markets?**

| Release | What Ships | Type | Main Gate | Decide By |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| R1 — Crawl | CMU closed beta; time/budget filters; saved preferences; no-match experience | Deterministic MVP | AC-01–AC-09 pass; 20% faster time-to-order; NPS stable | Nov 15, 2026 |
| R2 — Walk | Six Bay Area campuses; improve based on CMU; 12-week holdout test | Deterministic expansion | 5%+ order-rate lift vs. holdout; reliability and NPS stable | Feb 15, 2027 |
| R3 — Run | National rollout in stages; strong coverage markets first; continue improving | Deterministic scale-up | Order-rate improvement holds; reliability and NPS stable; adjust if weaker in certain markets | May 15, 2027 |

## BETA & MARKET WINDOW

CMU → Bay Area → National, staged within the estimated 6–10 month opportunity window. Early testing catches usability and delivery problems before broader rollout.

## KEY CONSTRAINTS

- **Engineering resources:** Reuse existing DoorDash systems; keep R1 small to limit cost.
- **Technical debt:** Avoid separate recommendation system; minimize platform complexity.
- **Business impact:** Must increase orders or reduce decision time, not just change order placement.

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DECISION

# GO — start with the CMUSV beta

Approve the CMUSV closed beta to test whether Quick Meal reduces time-to-order by at least 20% without lowering NPS.

### USER VALUE

Students can compare fewer feasible meals and see estimated arrival times and all-in prices earlier.

### DELIVERY RELIABILITY

Estimated arrival times must be dependable. Restaurant availability, Dasher supply, traffic, and campus access vary by location, so expansion starts with campuses that have strong selection and delivery coverage.

### BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Quick Mea must generate additional orders, rather than shift existing orders into a different flow. The Bay Area holdout test will measure this, while we monitor whether fewer restaurant choices affect satisfaction and merchant exposure.

**Next:** Launch the CMUSV closed beta, measure ordering time and actual delivery performance, and expand only if the roadmap gates pass.

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PROTOTYPE DEMO

# See Quick Meal in Action

## Live demo:

## quick-meal-demo.ioenv.workers.dev

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APPENDIX A · CONCEPT FRAMEWORK

# Quick Meal leads on need, value and feasibility

| Concept | Real need | Business value | Feasible / defensible | RICE | Decision |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Quick Meal | Students skip meals when time-tight | Full-price orders in crunch | Prep + Dasher data | 300K | Selected |
| Student Value | Fees cause cart abandonment | New orders could outweigh subsidy cost | Rivals can match fee cuts | 210K | Not now |
| Item Reviews | Portion quality hard to judge from photos | Conversion + fewer quality refunds | Easy copy alone can feed Quick Meal | 125K | Later |

| Feature | Reach | Impact | Confidence | Effort (person-weeks) | RICE / MoSCoW |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Filter | 3M | 3 | 80% | 8 | 900K / Must |
| Options | 3M | 3 | 80% | 10 | 720K / Must |
| Price | 3M | 1 | 70% | 6 | 350K / Must |

Formula: R × I × C / E. Full framework from FINAL Product Plan-2. Inputs are supplied assumptions, not independent validation.

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APPENDIX B · ACCEPTANCE + RUN LOG

# Acceptance criteria are defined; raw run evidence is still open

| AC | Repo test | Feature | Condensed criterion |
|---|---|---|---|
| AC01/02/04/08 | e2e/list.spec.ts | Entry, budget, combine, ETA | Filters produce feasible list; all-in total; combined constraints; ETA range |
| AC03/07/09 | e2e/filters.spec.ts | Filters, saved default, pickup | 30 min / $20; reopen defaults; 1 mi pickup and fee behavior |
| AC05 | e2e/no-match.spec.ts | Explicit relax | $15 / 15 min none → $17 / 1; saved $15 unchanged |
| AC06 | e2e/menu.spec.ts | Paseo menu | Chicken first; Veggie 0.54 over; 3 fit |

**Coverage:** all 9 AC features preserved above. Reported prototype result: 7/7 checks passed.

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APPENDIX C · REFERENCES + SIZING

# Sources anchor the plan; sizing remains proxy-based

## SIZING ASSUMPTIONS

| Metric | Calculation | Output |
|---|---|---|
| TAM | 19.4M × 72% | 14M context |
| SAM | TAM × 67% | 9.4M context |
| Bay Area SOM | 141,017 × 72% × 67% | ≈68K |
| Annual GOV | $555 spend proxy × student count | ≈$38M SOM |

Scenario: 20% adoption × 5% lift → ≈$0.4M beachhead GOV. National scenario: ≈$52M GOV / $7M revenue / $2.6M contribution profit; retained student ≈$135/year. Assumptions, not observed lift.

## Sources


1. DoorDash, 2025 Delivery Trends (US), Dynata survey of 1,504 US adults, 2025 [VERIFY]
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3. FinanceBuzz with Bank of America, survey of 2,000 US adults, via PotatoPro, Sep 15, 2026 [VERIFY]
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14. Statista, Online food delivery in the U.S. [VERIFY]
15. Fall 2025 enrollment: UC Berkeley Quick Facts; Mercury News for SJSU, SF State and CSU East Bay, Dec 8, 2025; Stanford Common Data Set 2025–26 (mirrored copy); SCU At a Glance [VERIFY]
16. Who's really ordering all that DoorDash?, The Argument, Mar 12, 2026 [VERIFY]
17. McKinsey, The value of getting personalization right, or wrong, is multiplying, Nov 12, 2021 [VERIFY]
18. DoorDash, Sponsored Listings [VERIFY]


All sizing uses proxies and ceilings; $555 is the annual spend proxy multiplied by student counts. ≈68K is the Bay Area six-campus SOM, not the CMUSV beta.

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